

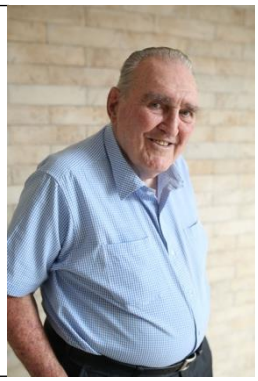
The Garamut
"The message sender"

Ps Barry Reflections from 'The WORD'!

For PRAYER, PROCLAMATION & PERSONAL PROGRESS

Bethel Global Missions

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THEME: PEOPLE OF THE WORD – THE WORD OF GOD.



1. **We need to be people of the Word OF God!**
2. **A people who KNOW the Word!**
3. **A people who HAVE God's Word IN their hearts - (aspects of His Word planted and resident in the heart).**

- **A people that READ the Word, HEAR the Word, RECEIVE INSTRUCTION and DIRECTION and CORRECTION from the Word.**
- **A people who have sufficient knowledge of the Word abiding in them so that they can at any time be able to discern whether some action, conduct, behavioural pattern or teaching (doctrine) is accurate or not - even if they are unable to fully explain or give a detailed theological answer.**

A PEOPLE LOVING THE WORD OF GOD AND LOVING THE THINGS THAT CHRIST LOVED.

The desperate need for today amongst Christians is getting them to return to reading the Word of God; including studying God's Word.
There is also a need for a personal renewing of A LOVE FOR THE WORD.
The kind of love that leads to a pleasurable daily exercise of hunger and desire for God's Word.

DID YOU KNOW?

THAT A LOVE FOR THE WORD NATURALLY LEADS TO A LOVE FOR CHRIST AND FOR THE THINGS THAT CHRIST LOVES – e.g. people, the lost, those disadvantaged, oppressed and bound by sin and its consequences.

IT'S NOT POSSIBLE TO LOVE JESUS, WITHOUT A COMMENSURATE LOVE FOR THE WORD OF GOD, because Jesus and the Word are one of the same.
Yet I have noticed that there are Christians who seem to think that a love for Jesus without a corresponding love for the Word of God is acceptable.
That giving prominence to loving God at the neglect of loving his Word is incompatible.
Sadly, it seems that today there is less desire to read the Word of God among many, too many of God's people.

A LACK OF LOVE FOR THE WORD OF GOD, WILL AFFECT THE LEVEL OF OUR LOVE FOR GOD AND CHRIST, AND THIS IN TURN WILL PRODUCE A LOWERING OF OUR CONCERN (LOVE) FOR THE LOST.

CONCLUSION.

OUR PASSION FOR THE LOST IS PROPORTIONATE THE POSITION THAT THE WORD OF GOD AND CHRIST HAVE IN OUR AFFECTIONS.

LOVING THE WORD AND LOVING JESUS LEADS TO LOVING WHAT JESUS LOVES THE MOST; AND THAT IS THE SALVATION OF THE LOST SINNER.

THE PRACTICAL ASPECTS OF GOD'S WORD AT WORK IN THE BELIEVER'S LIFE.

It is God's design that His Word be effectively operating in the Christians life daily.

In John 15:7 states about the Word abide or lives or has its residence (home) in the Christian believer.
That means that believer is comfortable with the Word making its home in them and for the Word to speak into and effectively influence their character and lifestyle.
John 15:7 If ye abide in me, and my Words abide in you, ye shall ask what ye will, and it shall be done unto you. KJV
John 15:7 If you live in Me [abide vitally united to Me] and My Words remain in you and continue to live in your hearts, ask whatever you will, and it shall be done for you. AMP
Now the apostle John records Christ's words stating that his disciples (us) continue to abide, staying vitally united with him AND for Christ's Word to be living and abiding in them.

SO, FOLLOWING CHRIST'S INSTRUCTION, I WANT TO PRESENT YOU AN ACTIVITY THAT EVERY CHRISTIAN SHOULD ENGAGE IN ON A REGULAR BASIS, PREFERABLY DAILY.

THIS IS THE ACTIVITY THAT EVERY BELIEVER SHOULD NOT ONLY ACTIVELY ENGAGE IN BUT CONTINUE TO DO SO EVERY DAY.

HERE IS A SIMPLE OVERVIEW OF THE STEPS TO BE TAKEN BY EVERY BELIEVER.

1. **IT IS THE DAILY APPLICATION OF THE WORD OF GOD TO OUR HEARTS. Not just choosing passages that we love, our favourite scriptures.**
2. **AND THEN MAKE AN HONEST APPRAISAL OF WHAT OUR HEARTS RESPONSE WAS TO THAT WORD.**
3. **AND THEN WHAT TO DO WITH THAT RESPONSE?**

THE FIRST STEP is for us to daily read some aspect of God's Word and then deliberately and willingly APPLY that Word to our hearts daily – exposing our hearts to the scrutiny and searchlight of the Word of God. This means being transparent and accountable to the message that a particular aspect of the Word presents.

Examples of the different aspects of God's Word to be applied.

- **It might be about being kind, compassionate and loving.**
- **Or it might be being faithful to God, our marriage, our children.**
- **Or it could be about forgiveness and setting right outstanding wrongs or offences – so they permanently resolved.**
- **Or just our lack of closeness to God.**

THE SECOND STEP is for us to note what my heart's response is to that Word, portion or passage of scripture and the instruction or message that it presents.
Examples:

- **How did my heart react or respond, and was it in agreement with the Word or otherwise?**
- **Did I seek to forget it's message and try to put it aside – not facing it with openness because it is too difficult, too challenging and it possibly revealed a lack of surrender of areas of my life to God?**
- **Did I want to defer it to another time because it inconveniences my plans and what I want to do?**
- **Did I feel that I needed more time to process and work through the issues that the Word is confronting me with?**

❖ **THIS PROCESS OF REGULARLY EXPOSING OUR HEART TO GOD'S WORD AND ENDEAVORING WITH TRANSPARENCY AND HONEST VIEW OF OUR RESPONSE SHOULD BE THE NORMAL PATTERN OF LIVING FOR EVERY CHRISTIAN.**

❖ **BUT WHEN THIS PROCESS BREAKS DOWN OR CEASES TO OPERATE IN OUR DAILY LIVING, then it affects our spirituality and our fellowship with God (and with brethren) and also disadvantages us in our decision making.**

❖ **ARE WE ALLOWING THE WORD TO EVALUATE OUR LIVES?**